

JOSEPH POINTER

Enterprise Strategy & Modernization | Operational Portfolio Leadership | AI-Enabled Transformation

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EXECUTIVE PROFILE

Modernization works when strategy, operations, and people move together. I design and lead enterprise initiatives where frameworks, operating rhythms, and cross-functional teams convert ambiguity into measurable outcomes. At TIAA (Fortune 100, \$1.6T AUM), I built and ran an operating framework connecting seven Client Services business areas, conceived and launched CareerSpark (a 9-module AI capability platform for 16,000+ associates), and led workplace transformation for 3,000+ associates across six locations. Earlier, ten years at Pearson and Vangent serving Fortune 500 and federal clients. My M.S. in Instructional Technology grounds adoption work in design, not opinion.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Director, Business Management

February 2022 - Present

TIAA (Fortune 100 Financial Services, \$1.6T AUM | 16,000 Associates)

Business Manager (2016-2022) | Sr. Management Specialist (2013-2016) | Business Consultant (2011-2013)

Led enterprise initiatives across the Client Services organization (~3,000 associates). Currently lead the associate-transformation workstream of TIAA's Recordkeeping Transformation program. Partner across HR, Workplace Services, Facilities, Risk and Compliance, and IT.

Operational Portfolio Leadership & Modernization Frameworks

- **Multi-Unit Operating Framework:** Built and ran an operating framework that connected seven Client Services business areas. Identified and empowered business-specific liaisons to own tactical execution, led peer learning sessions, provided escalation support for complex issues, and worked with senior leaders on strategy across Workplace, Associate Engagement, and Rewards and Recognition. Each business moved at its own pace while staying strategically aligned across all seven units.
- **Workplace Modernization at Scale (2022-2024):** Led change strategy for 3,000+ associates across six locations through return-to-office, Denver consolidation (44% real estate footprint reduction, full hoteling adoption for 700+ associates, 5 floors vacated), and the Frisco Corporate Center opening for 500+ associates in a new 15-story building. Zero retention crisis. Recognized as Change Champion.
- **Recognition Program Modernization (2019-2025):** Diagnosed underused enterprise recognition as a systemic problem. Designed cycle-based program redesigns that grew formal recognitions 395%, with the Client Services organization growing from minimal participation to 34-44% of all TIAA enterprise recognitions. Managed \$500K annual budget. Earned a seat on the corporate platform selection team.

AI-Enabled Enterprise Strategy & Adoption

- **CareerSpark, Enterprise AI Capability Platform (2024-2025):** Conceived, designed, and launched a 9-module AI-powered capability platform for 16,000+ associates with full lifecycle ownership from discovery through governance, deployment, adoption strategy, and impact measurement. Drove sustained engagement through 30+ town halls and team sessions reaching 1,500+ associates directly.
- **Responsible AI Governance:** Partnered with Risk, Compliance, and Legal before launch to define what the platform could and could not do. No associate data on company servers. No AI-initiated actions. Human-in-the-lead prompt frameworks. Governance designed in from the start.
- **AI-Assisted Solution Development:** Built the CareerSpark Manager Guide on Amazon Q in one week, versus months traditionally, to prove out a new model for AI-accelerated development inside the enterprise.

Capability Design & Cross-Functional Delivery

- **Skills of the Future Curriculum (2024):** Led team of 7 to design 5 curriculum tracks (12-17 modules each) covering critical future and digital-first skills. 890 unique users, 1,156 engagement interactions.
- **Virtual Product Expo (2020):** Adapted the in-person Career Fair model into a Virtual Product Expo when COVID eliminated regional events, expanding reach from regional to company-wide. 800+ associates reached. Model replicated by 3+ teams.
- **Executive Read-Outs & Decision Forums:** Built and delivered executive-level read-outs for senior leaders, including townhalls, people-leader updates, and quarterly business reviews with clear narrative and decision-ready materials.

Product Leader & Enterprise Solutions Architect

2000 - 2011

Interactive Media / FT Knowledge / Pearson Performance Solutions / Vangent Human Capital

Continuous tenure through a chain of acquisitions, serving Fortune 500 enterprises and federal agencies.

- **Enterprise Modernization Consulting:** Led discovery engagements with Fortune 500 clients (Unilever, Bank of America, Verizon Wireless, GE Capital, Regions Bank) on capability strategy and adoption design. Translated findings into multi-year roadmaps aligning executive sponsors, technical owners, and end users around measurable outcomes.
- **Technical Solutions & Field Enablement:** Served as knowledge engineer, information architect, sales engineer, and training specialist across enterprise LCMS and ATS platforms. Surfaced field-driven enhancements for both products, with ATS improvements helping clients reduce hiring costs 50-80% and improve speed-to-hire 50%+.
- **Federal & Enterprise Delivery:** Sales engineer on the team that won enterprise ATS deals with the U.S. Department of Commerce (2010 Census) and Extra Space Storage. Deployed Revolver LCMS across 5 Fortune 500 enterprises, designing knowledge architecture that separated core content from contextual delivery (single-source publishing two decades before it was common).

INDEPENDENT AI BUILDS

- **Future Me, Answered (futuremeansanswered.com):** Live AI career-discovery platform built on Next.js, the Vercel AI SDK, and multi-provider AI. I conceived the product, designed the 5-stage discovery framework, and modeled the career data (922 paths with salary data, AI Resilience Scores, weighted decision matrices). Primary engineering by my brother.

LEADERSHIP CAPABILITIES

Strategy & Modernization: Operational Portfolio Management | Modernization Strategy | Process Optimization & Scale Initiatives | Framework Design & Governance | Organizational Readiness | Business Case Development | Risk & Compliance Partnership

Enterprise Delivery: Portfolio of Strategic Initiatives | Cross-Functional Influence (HR, Tech, Business, Risk, Legal) | Executive Read-Outs & Decision Forums | Stakeholder Management | Operating Rhythm | Budget Management (~\$500K) | Change Management

AI & Technology: AI Use Case Identification | Responsible AI Governance | AI Adoption Strategy | Hands-on AI Builder (ChatGPT, Claude, Gemini, Kiro, GitHub Copilot)

Learning & Capability Design: Instructional Design (M.S.) | Curriculum & Capability Strategy | Adoption Measurement | Lean for Financial Services | Microsoft Excel, PowerPoint, SharePoint, Copilot

EDUCATION & RECOGNITION

Master of Science, Instructional Technology - Bloomsburg University of Pennsylvania (4.0 GPA)

Bachelor of Arts, Art (Commercial Art) - Millersville University of Pennsylvania

Certifications: Lean for Financial Services, TIAA (inaugural class) | Google Generative AI for Leaders

Awards: "Face of TIAA" Values VIP (2025, top 4 company-wide) | Values Champion (2022, 2025) | Change Champion (2025)